

Fred Rice

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EDUCATION

M.S. Computer Science, *Rice University*
Houston, TX

Aug 2025 – May 2027 (expected)

B.S. Computer Science, *Rice University*
Houston, TX

Aug 2021 – May 2025

EXPERIENCE

Machine Learning Engineer Intern, *NBer*
San Francisco, CA

Jun 2026 – Aug 2026

- Built a membership-benefits prototype end to end — four-source feature pipeline, LightGBM ranker, and the Python/gRPC service that applies a benefit at order time — piloted to ~60,000 members over three monthly cycles.
- Found 81% of members never answered the benefit push, making the default rather than the model decisive for four in five; a ~40-line policy change lifted redemption 3.1pp against 0.8pp from the ranker.
- Traced an offline NDCG@3 gain of 0.61→0.74 that landed flat online to training–serving skew, diffing feature vectors across both paths; reported and defended the corrected, lower 0.68.
- Pressed the PM and lifecycle lead on whether redemption was the right metric, since it rewards benefits members would have used anyway; the question is now logged as open for the team.

PROJECTS

ClipPrompt — *macOS menu-bar utility*
Swift, SwiftUI, AppKit, URLSession

Aug 2026 – Sep 2026

- Built a macOS tool that routes clipboard contents through a saved prompt-and-model recipe; added an in-place chat window after observing that near-miss answers still sent him back to a browser.
- Implemented the menu-bar client in SwiftUI over AppKit with a Carbon-backed global hotkey and URLSession streaming, so answers arrive incrementally and each turn overwrites the clipboard.
- Measured cost and latency per recipe across models: ~\$0.002–\$0.011 per invocation, 2.1s median round trip on the smallest model and 4–6s on larger ones.
- Daily driver with ~12 outside users and 71 GitHub stars, built across three weekends largely with a coding agent; shipped a next-day fix for an externally reported bug.